

Disk Druid—take it easy

After you have selected the Windows partition for installing Linux, you have to identify the respective partition in the Disk Druid menu. If your hard disk is connected as a Primary Master, it will be shown as hda, and a primary slave will be shown as hdb. Similarly, hdc and hdd will be shown for secondary master and slave respectively. Further, the first primary partition of the hard disk will be shown as hda1 and the next primary or extended partition will be shown as hda2 and so on. The Windows partition—the C drive, usually would be the first entry in this menu. Subsequent drives can be mapped to the next entry. For example, the D drive would be second entry, followed by the E drive and so on. But you have to ignore the entry for extended partition, as it is only a combination of the logical partitions under it.

Please note this will not be applicable

if your system has more than one hard disks and it runs on Windows 9x. This is because Windows 9x lists all the primary partitions before listing the logical partitions. You can check the number of hard disks and primary partitions your system has using fdisk. After starting fdisk, you will be presented with a menu having options to display the partition information and to change the current disk, among others. Note that the option to change the current disk will be shown only if you have more than one hard disk. Select the choice to display the partition information for the current disk. It will show all the partitions along with their details such as type, size, usage, etc. Then, change your current disk and display each partition's information. Using this information, you can now relate the Windows partitions to the ones mentioned in the Disk Druid menu.

unprobed monitor and enter your monitor's horizontal and vertical sync.

STEP 4 Select your screen colour depth, resolution and login type in the next screen.

A screen will appear, confirming the completion of installation. Remove the CD from the drive and click next. The system will now be rebooted. The boot loader will start, and give you two options—DOS and Linux. Select Linux to enter the world of Linux.

Un-installing

If at all you need to revert back to the previous state that your system was in, follow these steps. First, if you are using Windows 98:

STEP 1 Go to the command prompt and clear the MBR by entering `fdisk /mbr` in the command prompt.

STEP 2 Then, to delete the Linux partitions, use Ranish partition manager (found on the Mindware CD). Run the Ranish partition manager, select the Linux etx3 partition and delete it.

STEP 3 Now a free partition will be shown in the menu. Select this free partition and start the partition wizard by pressing the Enter key.

STEP 4 Select the file system as FAT 32 and leave the size field as it is. Next, select the 'Save changes now' option. In the next menu, select the Format now option, and after that, select the

'Quick format without surface test' option. Then, restart the system.

There is no support for fdisk in Windows XP. Hence, to clear MBR, you have to boot into the system using the Recovery Console. The recovery console is a command line-based diagnostic tool. It has many features such as enabling and disabling services, format drives, etc. You must be an administrator to use the Recovery Console. Follow these steps to restore your Windows XP system.

STEP 1 You can install it from the Windows XP setup CD by typing `{X}:i386\winnt32.exe /cmd-cons` in the Run dialog box, where {X} is your CD drive letter.

STEP 2 Restart the system and select DOS from the boot loader options.

Now, you will be presented with a menu that has two options—Windows XP and Windows recovery console. Select the latter.

STEP 3 If you have more than one version of Windows installed, you will be presented a menu of these. Then, select the Windows version where XP is installed, and clear the mbr by giving the `fixmbr` command at the prompt.

STEP 4 To remove the Linux partitions, boot into Windows, right-click My Computer and click on Manage. In the left side pane, select Disk management. On the right side, the systems view of the disk will be shown. Here, the Linux partition will be shown as an unrecognised partition that you need to delete.

STEP 5 The system will now show an unused partition. Select the partition and right-click it. From the menu, select create logical partition and then choose the file system and size. Now the system is back to normal.

That leaves your system in its original state. **d**

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